

Withdrawal Symptoms

After the AIIMS controversy, Health Minister Anbumani Ramadoss has now served derecognition notices to two Manipal Group medical colleges, which are among the country's most reputed



■ **By Stephen David in Manipal**

He's at it again. It wasn't too long ago that the courts had the last word on Anbumani Ramadoss's All India Institute of Medical Sciences crusade. Now the health minister has lined up one of the country's largest educational houses, the Manipal Group, in his sights. The group, with nearly 15,000 students from around 50 countries, is the latest to be at the receiving end of Ramadoss's fury with two of its medical colleges—Kasturba Medical Colleges (KMC) in Manipal and Mangalore—being served derecognition

notices last fortnight.

The derecognition of the KMCS, which regularly feature in the INDIA TODAY list of top 10 Indian medical schools, followed a recommendation by regulatory body Medical Council of India (MCI) and the Union Health Ministry. Inadequate infrastructure, shortage of faculty and excessive intake of students were among the observations that led to the notice. The council also objected to Malaysian students being given the medical degree as part of the twinning programme with the Manipal University's own arm, Melaka Manipal Medical College in Malaysia. It also expressed disapproval regarding

FUTURE TENSE: Fate of around 250 students lies in limbo as KMCs are asked to reduce the intake by half

the enrolment of students from Antigua and the West Indies.

The colleges were asked to address the observations and the Centre asked the state Government for a report. Karnataka Medical Education Minister Ramachandra Gowda says, "There were a few things to be rectified that have now been done. The Centre should now restore full recognition as this group is one of the largest in the state and is known for its standards. Also, we are not comfortable

"We have been unnecessarily discriminated against."

RAMDAS PAI, CHAIRMAN, MANIPAL GROUP

